

Google Business Profile, step by step

Thirty-one steps in the order Google asks for them. Tick each one as you finish it, and do them in this order — steps 12 and 24 are the two that decide whether this works.

For Ednar Nankya at Rayla Digital Agency. September 2026.

First

Before you open the laptop

Twenty minutes of gathering saves an hour of stopping halfway. Do not start step 1 until every box here is ticked.

- ☐ **The phone number, decided.** The website says +256 764 065 441. Google's listing says 0746 065441, which is +256 746 065 441. The middle digits are swapped, so one of them is wrong. Ring both if you have to, then write the right one below.
- ☐ **The password for hello@rayladigitalagency.com**, tested by signing in at mail.zoho.com. You have to read an email there at step 5, and finding out then that you cannot get in stops everything.
- ☐ **Your URSB certificate**, on paper or photographed on your phone.
- ☐ **The pictures, already on the laptop:** a square logo at least 720 by 720, a landscape cover photo at least 1080 wide, and eight to twelve real photographs of the team, the work and the space.
- ☐ **The address you will give Google**, if there is one. It will not be shown to anybody.
- ☐ **Ninety minutes, a charged phone, and nobody needing you.**

The phone number you settled on

Step 20 asks for it in this format: +256 7XX XXX XXX

The address you will give Google, if there is one

Step 17 asks for it. It stays hidden from customers either way. Leave this blank if there is none yet.

Make the account

This is the account that will own the profile. Get it right and nothing later can take the listing away from Rayla.

1 ☐ Sign out of every other Google account

Go to google.com, click your picture at the top right, and choose *Sign out of all accounts*. Or open a private window and do all of this inside it.

Whichever account is signed in when you claim the profile becomes its permanent owner. This is the reason for the step.

2 ☐ Open the signup page

Go to

accounts.google.com/signup

If Google asks who the account is for, choose the **personal** option. The business option leads to paid Google Workspace, which Rayla does not need for this.

3 ☐ Fill in the name and date of birth

First name **Rayla**, last name **Digital Agency**. For the date of birth, use your own.

4 ☐ Choose “Use my current email address instead”

Google now offers to create a new address ending in [@gmail.com](mailto:). **Do not take it.** Underneath that box is a small link reading *Use my current email address instead*. Click that, then type:

Type exactly

hello@rayladigitalagency.com

This makes the Zoho address into a Google account. Nothing about Zoho changes, and the enquiries from the website keep arriving where they arrive now.

If you miss the link you end up with a Gmail address instead, and the only fix is to start the signup again. It is small and it is easy to walk past.

5 ☐ Read the code in Zoho and type it back

Google sends a six-digit code to hello@rayladigitalagency.com. Open **mail.zoho.com** in another tab, sign in, find the email from Google, and type the code into the signup page.

Nothing after five minutes? Check the spam folder first. Then check whether hello@ forwards somewhere else, because the code goes wherever the mail actually lands.

6 ☐ Set the password, and store it properly

Somewhere a second person at Rayla can reach it if your phone is lost. Not only in your head, and not only on the phone itself.

7 ☐ Turn on 2-Step Verification

Go to

myaccount.google.com

Then Security, then 2-Step Verification, and follow it through with your phone.

8 ☐ Add a recovery phone and a recovery email

Same Security page. Recovery runs through the Google account, not through the business listing — so if these are not set and current, there is no route back to the profile at all.

Do not start Part two until steps 7 and 8 are done

Once the profile is verified, this account is the only thing standing between Rayla and losing the listing. Five minutes now, or a fight with Google later.

Part two

Claim the listing that already exists

Rayla is already on Maps as RAYLA DIGITAL, and nobody owns it. You are claiming it, not creating it.

9 ☐ Check which account you are signed in as

Top right of the screen. It must say **hello@rayladigitalagency.com**. If it says anything else, sign out and sign back in as hello@ before going any further.

10 ☐ Open the claim page

Go to

business.google.com/add

11 ☐ Type the name, then click the listing that appears

Type

Rayla Digital

A dropdown opens under the box with *RAYLA DIGITAL, Marketing agency* in it. Click that.

Do not click “Create a business with this name”, which sits underneath. That makes a second, duplicate listing, and duplicates are the most common reason new profiles get suspended.

If the existing listing does not appear

Stop and use the other route instead: open the Google Maps app on your phone, search Rayla Digital, open the listing, scroll all the way to the bottom, and tap *Claim this business*. The phone app shows it far more reliably than the website. If neither works, ask before creating anything.

If Google says the business is already claimed

Choose *Request access* and fill in the form. Google emails whoever holds it and gives them three to seven days to answer. Then wait. Do not create another listing while you wait.

Part three

The business name

Read this whole part before doing any of it. It is the field that gets profiles suspended, and it is the one you asked about.

12 ☐ Find the name on screen, and try to click into it

It will read **RAYLA DIGITAL**. Click into the box. What happens next decides which of these two you do.

If you can type in it, correct it now, before verifying

This is much the best moment. The verification that comes later is then done against the right name, and it will match the URSB certificate and the signage you show. Delete everything in the box and type this, exactly:

Type exactly

Rayla Digital Agency

Capital R, capital D, capital A. Three words. Nothing before it, nothing after it.

If the box is greyed out and will not let you type

Leave it. It gets corrected at **step 27**, after verification, and that works perfectly well. Do not abandon the claim in order to start a fresh listing with the right name — that is how you end up with two.

13 ☐ Add nothing to the name. Ever.

Not today, not at step 27, not in six months when someone suggests it would help with searching.

None of these are allowed

- ✗ Rayla Digital Agency Kampala
- ✗ Rayla Digital Agency | Social Media & Branding
- ✗ Rayla Digital Agency - Marketing
- ✗ RAYLA DIGITAL AGENCY

Adding words to the name is the most reported violation there is, and it is competitors who report it. The full capitals are not allowed either: Google only permits them where the brand is genuinely styled that way. **Three words, in that capitalisation, and stop.**

Part four

What kind of business, and what it does

Two questions Google asks in this order. The first one changes what the rest of the form looks like.

14 ☐ “What kind of business is this?” — choose service business

Three options: online retail, local store, service business. Rayla is a **service business** — work is delivered at the client's place or remotely, not bought off a shelf.

This is the answer that lets you keep the address private and list the areas you travel to. The other two do not.

15 ☐ Primary category

Choose

Marketing agency

Google has already put this on the listing, so it may be filled in for you. If it is, leave it exactly as it is.

16 ☐ Additional categories: four to six of them

Type each one and pick it from Google's dropdown. You can only choose what Google offers, and its list changes, so take the nearest thing it gives you.

- Internet marketing service
- Video production service
- Graphic designer
- Marketing consultant
- Social media agency — only if Google offers it

Stop at six. Google allows more, but every category is a promise that Rayla does that thing. Enquiries you have to turn down send people straight back to the search results, and Google reads that as a bad match.

Where Rayla is, and where it travels

17 ☐ The address

If Rayla has an address

Type it in full, then **drag the map pin onto the actual doorway**. Google's automatic pin lands on the wrong side of the road more often than not, and that pin is what a client's navigation follows.

If Rayla has no address yet

Choose the option to carry on without one. Verification then goes by phone, email or video instead of by post — which is faster anyway. Google will ask again later, and you can add it whenever there is one.

18 ☐ When Google asks whether to show the address, answer no

This is the whole point of choosing service business at step 14. The address stays with Google, who use it to check Rayla is where it says it is. The public sees only the areas in the next step.

Never a PO box, a coworking desk, a virtual office or a friend's address. Google looks for these specifically and removes the profiles that use them, usually without warning.

19 ☐ Service areas: five, and only five

Add these five

Kampala Wakiso District Entebbe Mukono Jinja

Type each one and pick it from Google's suggestions; it will not accept free text.

Google allows twenty. Do not use twenty. Service areas do not make Rayla rank in more places — that comes from where the pin is — so a long list only makes the profile look like it is claiming work it cannot do. Nothing outside Uganda, however much remote work there is; the website handles that.

How people reach Rayla

20 ☐ Phone number, in international format

The one you wrote on the first page of this sheet, typed as **+256 7XX XXX XXX**.

Keep that phone beside you from here on. If Google chooses to verify by call or text, the code arrives on it.

21 ☐ Website

Type exactly

<https://www.rayladigitalagency.com>

With the <https://> and with the [www](https://www.rayladigitalagency.com). Not the short version, not a shortened link.

If Google offers an appointment or booking link as well, point it at **<https://www.rayladigitalagency.com/#contact>**.

Part seven

Verification

Nothing on the profile is public until this is done. It is also the step where waiting is the whole job.

22 ☐ Choose video if it is offered

Google offers one or more of: a recorded video, a live video call, a phone call or text, an email, or a postcard. Take **video**, or **phone**. Take the postcard only if it is the only option – postcards to Kampala addresses are slow and frequently never arrive.

23 ☐ If it is a recorded video, film it in one take

One continuous take. No cuts, no editing, no music. In this order:

1. Outside: the street, the building, and the signage.
2. The walk in from the street to where you work, so the two connect.
3. Inside: desks, cameras, lights, computers – the tools the business runs on.
4. Proof you are the one running it: unlocking a door or a drawer, opening the URSB paperwork, signing in to hello@rayladigitalagency.com on screen.

Talk as you film. Daylight. Keep other people's faces out of it unless they have said yes.

24 ☐ Submit it, and then stop

If it is rejected, read the reason Google gives before recording again. You are usually allowed another attempt.

Change nothing until Google replies

It takes anywhere from a few minutes to five working days. While you wait: do not change the name, do not change the address, do not create another profile, and do not start a second listing to "try again".

Each of those restarts the process. Some of them end it.

After the green tick

Start this only once Google says the profile is verified. Everything here is safe to do in one sitting except steps 27 and 29, which have their own timing.

25 ☐ Opening hours, honestly

Including Saturday, and whether the office closes over lunch. Then set special hours for the public holidays you close on.

26 ☐ The description, then the services

About 750 characters. Lead with what Rayla does and where it does it, because that first sentence is all most people read. **Keep the phone number and the website out of it** – Google strips them and it reads as spam.

Then the services, with a line of description each: Digital Content Production, Social Media Management, Content Strategy, Graphic Design, Brand Consulting, Digital Marketing.

27 ☐ If the name still says RAYLA DIGITAL, change it now

Only if step 12 would not let you. Wait until the profile actually says verified, then change the name **and nothing else that week**.

Type exactly

Rayla Digital Agency

Have the URSB certificate to hand. If Google queries the change, the name on that document is the whole answer.

Google may take a few days to review it. That is normal, and the profile stays live while it does.

28 ☐ Photos: logo first, then the cover, then the rest

Give the files descriptive names before uploading. Then add two or three a month rather than emptying the whole archive today – profiles that get new photos regularly are shown noticeably more often.

29 ☐ A week after the name change, fix the map pin

It currently sits well north of Kampala rather than where the business is. One change, then a week, then the next. Several edits landing at once send the profile back into review.

30 ☐ Add the team as Managers

Settings, then *People and access*, then Add. Choose **Manager**, never Owner. Managers can post, reply to reviews, upload photos and edit the details. Only you can add people, remove people, or transfer the business.

31**Ask five clients for a review, one message at a time**

The profile gives you a short review link. Send it to clients whose work has just landed well, individually, in a message that mentions what you did for them. Reply to every review that comes back, warm or difficult, within a few days.

Never pay for a review, and never post one yourself

Not from a staff phone, not from family, not in exchange for airtime or a discount. Google detects reviews arriving together from related devices and deletes them, and repeat attempts can cost the profile permanently. It is the one thing on this sheet that cannot be undone.

If something goes wrong**Two rules, whatever has happened****Do not create a second profile**

Whatever the problem is — a rejected video, a suspension, a claim that will not go through — a duplicate listing makes it worse, and usually makes it permanent.

Do not delete anything. Read the notice instead.

It names the specific thing that is wrong. Fix that one thing, then use the reinstatement link in the notice itself. Appeals usually resolve within a couple of weeks.

Rayla Digital Agency hello@rayladigitalagency.com rayladigitalagency.com The longer guide covers the reasoning behind every step on this sheet.